THE MADE REAL BLUEPRINT / STEP 2

A rented house with land in the Serra do Açor, *inland from Coimbra – around Góis, Arganil or Pampilhosa da Serra.*

Portugal · Coimbra district · around Góis

Anna · 14 March 2027

THE LIFE AROUND THE HOUSE



Travel times as I recorded them, not measured on a map. A green dot is something I checked; an ochre dot is still an estimate.

Go further with this place

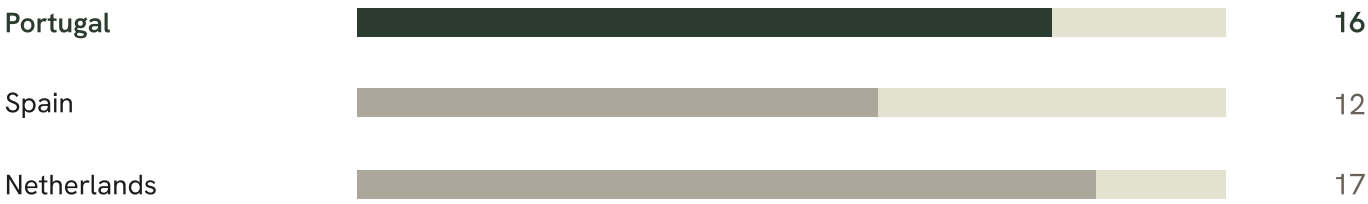
It does not give me a market town on the doorstep. The nearest proper market is twenty-five minutes away, and I have decided I can live with that.

FROM RESEARCH TO REAL LIFE

What I learned here

Eight days in February gave me what the research could not: an ordinary winter week, with laundry, bad internet weather and nothing special happening.

COUNTRIES / MY SCORES OUT OF 20



My own scores on the workbook's ten factors. The highest total is not automatically the right answer; it is a way of seeing where they differ.

THE VISIT / IN MY OWN WORDS

> "On the Wednesday it rained all day, I worked until two and then walked to the village in the wet, and it still felt like my life."

AN ORDINARY WEEK

> "How quiet the valley is after eight in the evening, and how far away everyone I know would be."

WHAT I WOULD RATHER NOT HAVE SEEN

WHAT CHANGED

The house: the cold old places I had been looking at are not workable, so I am looking at newer rentals.
The language: fewer people spoke English than I expected, so I start lessons now.
The distance: Lotte would be a flight away, not a drive.

THE NEXT CHECKS

More real than the guess

Step 1 · what I guessed a month would cost **€2,245**

Step 2 · what I found **€2,360**

What I found is €115 more than I guessed. About €2,360 a month, checked against real bills in February rather than brochure figures.

–€710

a month, on the income I can count on

€1,650 confirmed from the three clients. Everything above that is hoped for, not counted.

OPEN BEFORE THE NEXT DECISION

- Whether the fibre holds in a storm.
- What the house really costs to heat in January.
- Whether I will still want this in my third winter.

MY NEXT SMALL STEP / REVIEW ON MID-DECEMBER 2027

Book a second visit in April, alone, for ten days

My legal route, as I recorded it: Residency as a self-employed person. I must prove steady income, health cover and an address.